

need to provide your Gmail user ID. Thunderbird will automatically configure the POP and SMTP server settings for your Gmail account.

To set up your RSS news feed, you need to specify an account name. To connect to a news server, you need to specify the address of a news server which is serving news over the NNTP protocol. The news server is somewhat older technology which has been largely replaced by blogs, which are much easier to host and subscribe to.

For some e-mail accounts there might be a requirement for special security settings. In that case, your organisation should provide clear, simple instructions on how to configure Thunderbird with their security settings. If they don't, ask them! Thunderbird is an increasingly popular choice as an e-mail client and they should—generally speaking—provide configuration instructions and support for non standard settings.

6.1.3 Setting up your Gmail or regular e-mail account

GMail is especially noteworthy for providing free POP access to their users. That is, users can choose to download their e-mail to a client like Thunderbird and/or view it on the Web! The choice is entirely up to you.

The steps to configure a regular e-mail account are similar to configuring your Gmail account, and will require only one extra step—where you specify the POP and SMTP server names as explained above.

Select the Gmail radio button and click Next in the Account Setup Wizard. Enter your name and Gmail user-name and click Next. That's it—you're done! As explained above, Thunderbird has auto-



Setting up your accounts in Thunderbird is a snap